

United States History and Geography — Teacher Key

United States History and Geography · Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28 · Form FORM-A

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classroom-formative · pre-field-test. Item parameters are estimates and have not met a student; this form is not a calibrated instrument.

1. What did the Reconstruction Finance Corporation (RFC) do under Hoover?

- A. Raised tariffs to the highest levels in U.S. history, worsening the global Depression
- B. Loaned government money to banks, railroads, and large businesses to prevent failures
- C. Businesses cut wages and jobs anyway to survive; voluntary measures had no enforcement
- D. WWI veterans demanding early bonus payment; Hoover ordered military to disperse them

KEY: B · DOK 1 · US.46

Why the key is right: The RFC was Hoover's main federal intervention: it lent public money to banks, railroads and large firms on the theory that keeping big institutions solvent would stop failures cascading down to workers. That 'top-down' logic is why the RFC is the standard contrast with the New Deal's direct relief.

A — Raising tariffs was the Hawley-Smoot Tariff of 1930, a separate Hoover-era policy that restricted trade rather than lending money.

C — This describes the failure of Hoover's voluntary-cooperation approach, in which he asked business to hold wages. The RFC was the opposite: a funded federal lender.

D — This is the Bonus Army episode of 1932, a protest by WWI veterans. It is an event, not an agency, and had no lending function.

2. What was the Bonus Army and how did Hoover respond?

- A. Businesses cut wages and jobs anyway to survive; voluntary measures had no enforcement
- B. Raised tariffs to the highest levels in U.S. history, worsening the global Depression
- C. WWI veterans demanding early bonus payment; Hoover ordered military to disperse them
- D. Loaned government money to banks, railroads, and large businesses to prevent failures

KEY: C · DOK 1 · US.46

Why the key is right: The Bonus Army and how did Hoover respond was WWI veterans demanding early bonus payment; Hoover ordered military to disperse them, which made Hoover seem harsh toward struggling veterans. Choice B is wrong because it does not describe the veterans' demand for early bonus payments, and choice C is wrong because it does not describe the veterans' demand for early bonus payments. Public frustration with Hoover helped shift many voters toward the New Deal in 1932.

A — This describes why Hoover's voluntary wage-maintenance appeals failed, not the veterans' bonus demand.

B — This is the Hawley-Smoot Tariff, a trade policy unrelated to the veterans' march.

D — This is the Reconstruction Finance Corporation, a lending agency, not a protest.

3. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows a TVA dam completed during the New Deal era. (Photograph, c. 1936. Public Domain.) How did New Deal programs like the TVA, shown in this photograph, represent a change in the role of the federal government?

- A. The government reduced its involvement in the economy and allowed private industry to manage recovery
- B. The federal government's role remained unchanged from the policies of the 1920s
- C. The TVA was a private utility corporation that operated without any federal funding or oversight
- D. The federal government took direct responsibility for economic development and public welfare

KEY: D · DOK 2 · US.46

Why the key is right: The TVA represented a dramatic expansion of federal power. For the first time, the government directly owned and operated an electric utility, planned regional economic development, and employed thousands of workers. This reflected FDR's philosophy that the government had a responsibility to ensure economic security and development.

A — The TVA is the clearest case of the opposite: the federal government built and ran dams and sold the power itself.

B — Federal public works on this scale had no 1920s precedent; that discontinuity is the point of the image.

C — The TVA was created by Congress in 1933 as a federally owned corporation. Reading it as private misses why critics called it socialism.

4. Why did critics of the New Deal charge that FDR's programs represented socialism?

- A. Because the New Deal greatly expanded federal regulation of the economy and created public employment and Social Security
- B. Because FDR eliminated private property rights by redistributing land from wealthy Americans to the poor
- C. Because New Deal programs abolished all private and religious charities in favor of state services
- D. Because FDR called for nationalizing all major American industries and placing them under government ownership

KEY: A · DOK 2 · US.46

Why the key is right: New Deal opponents — including business leaders and conservatives — argued that programs like the TVA (a government-owned utility), the AAA (government interference in markets), and Social Security (a government welfare program) crossed the line from capitalism into socialism by making the government a major economic actor.

B — Private property rights were not abolished; New Deal farm policy paid owners to limit production rather than redistributing their land.

C — Private and religious charities continued throughout the 1930s; federal relief supplemented them because their resources had been exhausted.

D — FDR never proposed nationalising major industries. The charge rested on regulation and public employment, not government ownership.

5. Design a "New Deal Report Card" that grades THREE specific programs on two criteria: (1) effectiveness in addressing the immediate crisis, and (2) long-term impact on American government and society. For each program, assign a letter grade (A-F) for each criterion and justify your grading with specific historical evidence.

KEY: — · DOK 3 · US.46

Why the key is right: A strong response should grade three New Deal programs separately for short-term relief and long-term impact, because a program like the CCC could help quickly while Social Security reshaped government for decades. It should justify each grade with evidence, such as immediate jobs from the CCC or the long-term survival of Social Security, and show that short-term success and lasting impact are not always the same. The controversy showed how Americans argued over the proper size and power of the federal government during the Great Depression.

6. DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION Directions: Analyze the three primary sources below. Then respond to the prompt using evidence from ALL THREE documents and your own historical knowledge. --- DOCUMENT A National Industrial Recovery Act, Section 1 (Declaration of Policy), June 16, 1933 (National Archives, public domain): "A national emergency productive of widespread unemployment and disorganization of industry, which burdens interstate and foreign commerce...is hereby declared to exist. It is hereby declared to be the policy of Congress to remove obstructions to the free flow of interstate and foreign commerce which tend to diminish the amount thereof; and to provide for the general welfare by promoting the organization of industry for the purpose of cooperative action among trade groups..." --- DOCUMENT B National Labor Relations Act (Wagner Act), Section 1 (Findings and Policy), July 5, 1935 (National Archives, public domain): "The inequality of bargaining power between employees who do not possess full freedom of association or actual liberty of contract, and employers who are organized in the corporate or other forms of ownership association substantially burdens and affects the flow of commerce...It is hereby declared to be the policy of the United States to eliminate the causes of certain substantial obstructions to the free flow of commerce...by protecting the exercise by workers of full freedom of association, self-organization, and designation of representatives of their own choosing." --- DOCUMENT C FDR, Message to Congress on Tax Revision, June 19, 1935 (FDR Presidential Library, public domain): "Our revenue laws have operated in many ways to the unfair advantage of the few, and they have done little to prevent an unjust concentration of wealth and economic power...The very wealthy may be able to hire the ablest tax lawyers so that the letter of the tax law is followed but not the spirit...Inherited economic power is as inconsistent with the ideals of this generation as inherited political power was inconsistent with the ideals of the generation which established our Government." --- PROMPT: Using all three documents and your knowledge of the New Deal (1933–1938), construct an argument that answers: How did the New Deal evolve from the First New Deal (1933–1934) to the Second New Deal (1935–1938), and what does this evolution reveal about FDR's response to political pressure from critics on both the left and right? In your response, you MUST: 1. Analyze each document using the HIPP framework — at least ONE HIPP element per document. 2. Place each document within the First or Second New Deal phase and explain what governing philosophy it reflects. 3. Construct a central argument using all three documents AND at least two outside historical facts explaining how the shift from Document A to Documents B and C reflects a meaningful philosophical and political evolution in the New Deal. 4. Evaluate: Was the Second New Deal a genuine ideological shift toward redistribution and worker empowerment, or primarily a political strategy to neutralize critics like Huey Long and the Supreme Court?

KEY: — · DOK 4 · US.43, US.45, US.46

Why the key is right: SCORING GUIDE (6 points): 6 - Exemplary: All three documents analyzed with accurate HIPP. Correctly places NIRA in First New Deal and Wagner Act/Tax Message in Second New Deal. Argues the evolution with evidence from all three documents plus two outside facts. Evaluation of genuine vs. strategic shift is nuanced and evidence-based. Historical writing is rigorous. 5 - Advanced: Three documents with HIPP (one may be less precise). Argument traces evolution with all three documents and at least one outside fact. Evaluation present with some nuance. 4 - Proficient: Two or three documents with some HIPP. Argument traces First to Second New Deal with evidence from at least two documents and one outside fact. Evaluation present. 3 - Adequate: Two documents referenced. Argument identifies evolution in general terms. Some HIPP. Limited outside knowledge. 2 - Developing: Minimal document analysis. Argument vague about evolution. Little outside knowledge. 1 - Beginning: One document summarized. No argument. No HIPP. 0 - No response or completely off-topic. DOCUMENT ANALYSIS EXPECTATIONS: - Doc A (NIRA): First New Deal; cooperative capitalism; Context = Hundred Days emergency legislation - Doc B (Wagner Act): Second New Deal; labor rights shift; Context = post-Schechter, Long threat - Doc C (FDR Tax): Second New Deal; redistributive rhetoric; Context = Share Our Wealth pressure KEY EVIDENCE EXPECTED: NIRA (1933) and Schechter Poultry v. United States (1935); Huey Long / Share Our Wealth (4.5 million members); Wagner Act (1935) and NLRB;

Social Security Act (1935); Works Progress Administration (1935); Revenue Act of 1935 ('Soak the Rich'); CIO formation (1935); GM sit-down strike (1936–1937).

7. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows American soldiers during the Korean War, c. 1950. U.S. forces were deployed to South Korea as part of a United Nations coalition after North Korean forces invaded South Korea in June 1950. (U.S. Army photograph, c. 1950. Public Domain.) The deployment of American troops shown in this photograph was part of the U.S. strategy of what?

- A. Imperialism
- B. Containment
- C. Détente
- D. Isolationism

KEY: B · DOK 1 · US.60

Why the key is right: The Korean War was a direct application of the U.S. containment policy, which aimed to prevent the spread of communism beyond its existing borders. When communist North Korea invaded South Korea, President Truman committed American forces to stop the expansion, consistent with the Truman Doctrine.

- A — Imperialism means acquiring territory. The stated aim in Korea was to hold a line, not to annex it.
- C — Détente was the 1970s easing of tensions under Nixon, two decades after Korea and opposite in posture.
- D — Isolationism is the refusal to intervene abroad. Sending troops to Korea is its contradiction.

8. Marshall's speech announced what became known as which initiative?

- A. The Berlin Airlift to the blockaded city
- B. The Eisenhower Doctrine for the Middle East
- C. The Marshall Plan for European recovery
- D. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization

KEY: C · DOK 1 · US.60

Why the key is right: The Marshall Plan, formally the European Recovery Program announced by Secretary of State George Marshall at Harvard on June 5, 1947, became the initiative the speech launched. Choice A is wrong because the Eisenhower Doctrine came a decade later (1957) and addressed the Middle East, not European recovery. Choice B is wrong because NATO was a military alliance signed in 1949, not the economic-aid program Marshall announced. Marshall Plan aid totaled \$13.3 billion to sixteen Western European nations between 1948 and 1952, anchoring containment through economic stabilization.

- A — The Berlin Airlift was a 1948–49 supply operation for one city, not a Europe-wide recovery programme.
- B — The Eisenhower Doctrine came a decade later, in 1957, and addressed the Middle East.
- D — NATO was a 1949 military alliance. The Marshall Plan was economic aid and came first.

9. Read the excerpt below. "The Grand Alliance between the United States, Great Britain, and the Soviet Union rests upon one thing only — our common enemy. When Hitler is defeated, I wonder what will hold us together." — Diplomat George Kennan, Private Memo, 1944 Which of the following best describes the fragility of the World War II Allied alliance referenced in this excerpt?

- A. Personal conflicts between Roosevelt, Churchill, and Stalin made sustained military cooperation nearly impossible.
- B. The creation of the United Nations divided the Allies into competing blocs before the war even ended.
- C. The three Allies had agreed to share all military technology, creating economic competition that strained relations.
- D. The Alliance was held together only by a common enemy, masking ideological differences that surfaced once Germany was defeated

KEY: D · DOK 2 · US.60

Why the key is right: Kennan's prescient observation captures the fundamental weakness of the wartime Allied coalition: the U.S., Britain, and the Soviet Union had vastly different political systems, ideological commitments, and postwar goals. The only thing binding them was a common enemy. Once Germany was defeated, these differences rapidly emerged, leading to the Cold War. The ideological conflict between Western liberal democracy and Soviet communism made postwar cooperation impossible. Option A is incorrect because the differences were ideological and political, not merely personal between leaders. Option B is incorrect because economic cooperation was limited and strained even during the war. Option C is incorrect because the UN was created to manage these tensions, not a cause of the breakdown.

A — The source points to ideology, not personalities. The three leaders in fact sustained working cooperation through the war.

B — The United Nations was designed to keep the Allies cooperating after 1945, and the blocs hardened afterward rather than before the war ended.

C — The Allies did not share all military technology — the United States withheld the atomic programme from the Soviets entirely.

10. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows a U.S. Air Force C-54 Skymaster cargo plane flying low over a crowd of German civilians as it approaches Tempelhof Airport in Berlin during the summer of 1948. (Photograph, 1948. U.S. Air Force.) How did the Berlin Airlift shown in this photograph reflect the U.S. policy of containment during the early Cold War?

- A. The U.S. showed resolve against Soviet expansion without direct force
- B. The U.S. used military force to drive Soviet troops out of the eastern sector of Berlin
- C. The U.S. negotiated a peace treaty that divided Germany into permanent zones
- D. The U.S. imposed economic sanctions that forced the Soviet Union to end communism

KEY: A · DOK 2 · US.60

Why the key is right: The Berlin Airlift exemplified containment by resisting Soviet pressure over West Berlin through non-military means, demonstrating American commitment to opposing communist expansion without triggering direct armed conflict.

B — No Soviet troops were driven out. The airlift deliberately avoided force by flying over the blockade instead of breaking it.

C — Germany's division was not settled by a treaty during the airlift; the blockade ended in 1949 without one.

D — Sanctions were not the instrument, and Soviet communism continued for four more decades.

11. Compare the Marshall Plan (1948) with modern American foreign aid programs. What principles from the Marshall Plan's success could be applied to current challenges? What limitations would such an approach face today?

KEY: — · DOK 3 · US.60

Why the key is right: The Marshall Plan worked because it provided large-scale economic aid, encouraged European cooperation, and matched American self-interest with recovery in Western Europe. A strong response should compare those principles to modern foreign aid while also noting limits, such as weaker political consensus today and different conditions outside postwar Europe. This comparison shows how Cold War policy mixed idealism with strategic goals.

12. DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION: The Origins of the Cold War Directions: Read the following three primary source excerpts and then respond to the prompt below. In your response, analyze each document using the HIPP framework (Historical context, Intended audience, Purpose, Point of view) and construct an evidence-based argument. --- **DOCUMENT A:** George Kennan, "The Long Telegram," February 22, 1946 — declassified U.S. State Department cable, available through the National Archives: "We have here a political force committed fanatically to the belief that with US there can be no permanent *modus vivendi*, that it is desirable and necessary that the internal harmony of our society be disrupted, our traditional way of life be destroyed, the international authority of our state be broken, if Soviet power is to be secured." **DOCUMENT B:** Winston Churchill, "The Sinews of Peace" (Iron Curtain Speech), Westminster College, Fulton, Missouri, March 5, 1946 — public address, transcript available through Westminster College archives: "From Stettin in the Baltic to Trieste in the Adriatic, an iron curtain has descended across the Continent. Behind that line lie all the capitals of the ancient states of Central and Eastern Europe... all are subject in one form or another, not only to Soviet influence but to a very high and in many cases increasing measure of control from Moscow." **DOCUMENT C:** Harry S. Truman, Address to Congress (Truman Doctrine), March 12, 1947 — U.S. government document, National Archives: "At the present moment in world history nearly every nation must choose between alternative ways of life. The choice is too often not a free one. One way of life is based upon the will of the majority... The second way of life is based upon the will of a minority forcibly imposed upon the majority." --- Using all three documents and your knowledge of Cold War origins (US.59–US.60), construct an argument that evaluates the relative roles of ideology and geopolitical strategy in causing the Cold War. Apply HIPP analysis to at least two of the three documents and use outside historical knowledge to support your argument. Your response should address: (1) what each document reveals about U.S./Western perceptions of the Soviet threat; (2) whether the Cold War was primarily an ideological conflict or a geopolitical competition for power; and (3) whether alternative outcomes were possible given the structural conditions of 1945–1947.

KEY: — · DOK 4 · US.60

Why the key is right: **SCORING GUIDE** (6 points): 6 - Exemplary: Presents a precise, historically arguable thesis on the ideology/geopolitics question. Applies full HIPP analysis to at least two documents, identifying historical context, audience, purpose, AND point of view for each. Uses outside historical evidence (minimum 3 specific facts) not from the documents. Addresses all three prompt components: perceptions, causation debate, and alternative outcomes. Demonstrates sophisticated understanding of historiographical debate. 5 - Advanced: Clear thesis. Full HIPP applied to two documents (may be incomplete on one element for one document). Two pieces of outside evidence. Addresses two of three prompt components thoroughly. 4 - Proficient: Arguable thesis. HIPP partially applied to two documents (addresses 2–3 elements per document). One piece of outside evidence. Addresses at least two prompt components. 3 - Adequate: General thesis. Analyzes at least two documents but without systematic HIPP. Uses document evidence but limited outside knowledge. Addresses one prompt component clearly. 2 - Developing: Basic claim. References at least one document but analysis is mostly summary. Minimal outside evidence. Prompt components addressed superficially. 1 - Beginning: Attempts a response. May reference documents but without analysis. Little to no outside evidence. Does not address prompt components. 0 - No response or off-topic. **DOCUMENT ANALYSIS EXPECTATIONS:** For Document A — HIPP should identify Kennan's diplomatic vantage point, State Dept. audience, warning purpose, and his trained diplomat's point of view that shaped his perception. For Document B — HIPP should note Churchill's political status, the American audience (Truman present), the galvanizing purpose, and Churchill's imperial Great Power point of view. For Document C — HIPP should identify the immediate Greece/Turkey crisis, the congressional audience, the funding request purpose, and Truman's Manichean framing as a political strategy. **KEY EVIDENCE EXPECTED:** Yalta and Potsdam tensions; Soviet satellite states (1945–1948); Soviet rejection of Marshall Plan; Berlin Blockade (1948–1949); Soviet atomic test (1949); Chinese Communist victory (1949); NSC-68 (1950) as ideological escalation.

13. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows the massive excavation of the Culebra Cut during construction of the Panama Canal, c. 1910. Workers and heavy equipment can be seen carving through the mountainous terrain of the Panamanian isthmus. (Photograph, c. 1910. Public Domain.) Which president was MOST responsible for initiating the construction project shown in this photograph?

- A. William McKinley
- B. Theodore Roosevelt
- C. William Howard Taft
- D. Woodrow Wilson

KEY: B · DOK 1 · US.23

Why the key is right: President Theodore Roosevelt championed the construction of the Panama Canal. After supporting Panama's independence from Colombia in 1903, Roosevelt negotiated the Hay-Bunau-Varilla Treaty to secure the Canal Zone. Construction began in 1904 and the canal opened in 1914.

- A — McKinley was president during the Spanish-American War and was assassinated in 1901, before canal construction began.
- C — Taft succeeded Roosevelt and oversaw later construction, but the acquisition and decision were Roosevelt's.
- D — Wilson took office in 1913, the year before the canal opened; he did not initiate it.

14. Use the political cartoon to answer the question. The 1898 cartoon shows Uncle Sam seated at a restaurant table, looking at a menu containing 'Cuba Steak,' 'Porto Rico Pig,' 'Philippine Floating Islands,' and 'Sandwich Islands (Hawaii).' President McKinley stands as the waiter. The cartoon comments on American territorial expansion after the Spanish-American War. In this cartoon, what does Uncle Sam being seated at the restaurant menu most directly represent?

- A. The United States refusing to accept any new territorial responsibilities after defeating Spain
- B. American diplomats negotiating new trade agreements with independent Caribbean republics
- C. The United States choosing which territories to acquire after defeating Spain
- D. President McKinley choosing between military options for fighting the Spanish-American War

KEY: C · DOK 1 · US.23

Why the key is right: A is correct: By depicting Uncle Sam choosing from a menu of territories like Cuba, Puerto Rico, the Philippines, and Hawaii, the cartoon represents the United States deciding which territories to acquire after defeating Spain in 1898. The restaurant metaphor makes territorial acquisition look like a consumer choice. B is incorrect: Uncle Sam is selecting from the menu, not refusing — the cartoon shows the U.S. as the decision-maker about which territories to take. C is incorrect: the menu items are territories, not trade agreements or diplomacy. D is incorrect: McKinley as the waiter suggests he is facilitating the choice, but the cartoon is about territorial selection, not a comparison of military options.

- A — A refusal would be shown by pushing the menu away. Reading the menu is the act of choosing.
- B — The territories on the menu were annexed or occupied, not treated as independent trading partners.
- D — The cartoon is dated after the fighting, and the menu lists territories rather than military options.

15. Read the excerpt below. "I took the Canal Zone and let Congress debate, and while the debate goes on, the canal does also." — President Theodore Roosevelt, Lecture at University of California, 1911 Which of the following best describes the controversy surrounding Roosevelt's acquisition of the Panama Canal Zone?

- A. Roosevelt used U.S. taxpayer money to pay other nations to build the canal without congressional authorization.
- B. Panama declared independence from Spain with U.S. support specifically to gain the economic benefits of the canal.
- C. Roosevelt seized the Canal Zone from France, which had originally agreed to sell it to the United States but then backed out.
- D. The U.S. backed Panama's revolution against Colombia to obtain the canal rights

KEY: D · DOK 2 · US.23

Why the key is right: Roosevelt's boastful admission that he 'took' the Canal Zone without waiting for Congress refers to the U.S. role in supporting Panama's revolution against Colombia. When Colombia refused to ratify the canal treaty, the U.S. encouraged Panamanian independence, recognized Panama immediately, and signed a favorable canal treaty. Critics argued this was an illegal use of presidential power and violated Colombia's sovereignty. Option A is incorrect because France originally attempted to build the canal, not Colombia. Option B is incorrect because the canal was not paid for by other nations. Option D is incorrect because Panama gained independence from Colombia, not from Spain.

A — The United States built the canal itself with its own workforce rather than paying other nations to build it.

B — Panama declared independence from Colombia, not Spain; Spain had lost its mainland American colonies eighty years earlier.

C — The French company sold its concession and equipment; the sovereignty dispute was with Colombia, not France.

16. Read the excerpt below. "The construction of the canal required the labor of tens of thousands of workers — Jamaicans, Barbadians, Spanish workers — in brutal tropical conditions. Yellow fever and malaria killed thousands before Dr. Gorgas brought the diseases under control." — David McCullough, *The Path Between the Seas*, 1977 Which of the following best describes a major challenge that had to be overcome to complete the Panama Canal?

- A.** Tropical disease, especially yellow fever and malaria, killed thousands of workers until a mosquito-control campaign cut the death rate
- B.** The lack of adequate explosives technology meant engineers had to rely entirely on hand-dug excavations.
- C.** The engineers had to redirect four major rivers that flooded the construction site annually.
- D.** The project faced a severe labor shortage because American workers refused to work in tropical conditions.

KEY: A · DOK 2 · US.23

Why the key is right: One of the greatest obstacles to building the Panama Canal was tropical disease — particularly yellow fever and malaria, which killed thousands of French workers in the earlier failed attempt. Dr. William Gorgas implemented a massive mosquito eradication campaign based on the theory that mosquitoes spread disease (then a new scientific understanding), which dramatically reduced the death rate and made the construction feasible. Option A is incorrect because the engineering challenge was the mountainous terrain, not river flooding (though landslides were a problem). Option B is incorrect because labor was plentiful — it was disease, not shortage of workers, that was the main challenge. Option C is incorrect because dynamite was readily available — the explosive used was a technological advance, not a limitation.

B — Dynamite and steam shovels were used extensively; the Culebra Cut was blasted, not dug by hand.

C — The Chagres River was dammed rather than redirected, and it was one river, not four.

D — There was no labour shortage: tens of thousands of Caribbean and European workers were recruited, which is what the source describes.

17. Analyze how American imperialism in the late 1800s reflected BOTH idealistic and self-interested motivations. Use evidence from at least THREE specific events or policies (e.g., Spanish-American War, annexation of Hawaii, Open Door Policy, Panama Canal, Philippine-American War). Then evaluate whether imperialism ultimately strengthened or weakened American democratic ideals.

KEY: — · DOK 3 · US.23

Why the key is right: A strong response should show that American imperialism mixed idealistic language about spreading liberty or “civilization” with self-interested goals such as new markets, naval bases, and national prestige. It should use at least three specific examples, such as the Spanish-American War, annexation of Hawaii, the Open Door Policy, the Panama Canal, or the Philippine-American War, and then judge whether those actions strengthened or weakened democratic ideals. This prompt is important because it asks students to weigh American expansion against the nation’s stated commitment to self-government.

18. Document-Based Question: The Spanish-American War and the Question of Empire, 1898 Directions: Read the three documents below. Then write a well-organized essay that constructs an argument addressing the following question: Did the Spanish-American War represent a turning point in American foreign policy, or was it the inevitable product of forces already at work in American society and politics? Your essay must: — Apply SOAPS analysis (Speaker, Occasion, Audience, Purpose, Significance) to at least two of the three documents — Use evidence from all three documents — Incorporate outside knowledge of the period — Construct a clear, defensible argument --- DOCUMENT 1 President William McKinley, War Message to Congress, April 11, 1898 — Bryan, William Jennings, ed., *Republic or Empire* (1899), public domain, public domain: "The present condition of affairs in Cuba is a constant menace to our peace and entails upon this Government an enormous expense. With such a conflict waged for years in an island so near our border and with which our people have such trade and business relations; when the lives and liberty of our citizens are in constant danger and their property destroyed and themselves ruined; where our trading vessels are liable to seizure and are seized at our very door by warships of a foreign nation — the expedient of enforcing American interests will justify forceful intervention." --- DOCUMENT 2 Teller Amendment, April 20, 1898, Bryan, William Jennings, ed., *Republic or Empire* (1899), public domain — public domain: "Resolved by the Senate and House of Representatives... That the United States hereby disclaims any disposition or intention to exercise sovereignty, jurisdiction, or control over said Island except for the pacification thereof, and asserts its determination, when that is accomplished, to leave the government and control of the Island to its people." --- DOCUMENT 3 Platt Amendment, 1901, Statutes at Large of the United States — public domain: "The government of Cuba consents that the United States may exercise the right to intervene for the preservation of Cuban independence, the maintenance of a government adequate for protecting life, property, and individual liberty, and for discharging the obligations with respect to Cuba imposed by the Treaty of Paris on the United States... Cuba will sell or lease to the United States lands necessary for coaling or naval stations at certain specified points to be agreed upon with the President of the United States."

KEY: — · DOK 4 · US.22, US.23

Why the key is right: SCORING GUIDE (6 points): 6 - Exemplary: Complex thesis addressing both 'turning point' and 'inevitable product' dimensions. SOAPS analysis of at least two documents accurately and specifically. Cross-document synthesis (Teller → Platt contradiction). Extensive outside knowledge. Well-organized argumentative essay. 5 - Advanced: Clear thesis. SOAPS applied to at least two documents accurately. Good outside knowledge. Addresses the Teller/Platt contradiction but may not fully develop the 'turning point vs. inevitable' framework. 4 - Proficient: Clear thesis. Uses all three documents as evidence. SOAPS applied to at least two documents with reasonable accuracy. Some outside knowledge. Coherent argument. 3 - Adequate: Thesis present but simple. Uses two or more documents. Some SOAPS elements. Limited outside knowledge. Some organizational issues. 2 - Developing: Weak or no thesis. Uses one or two documents without SOAPS. Little outside knowledge. Descriptive rather than argumentative. 1 - Beginning: No thesis. Minimal document use. No SOAPS. No outside knowledge. 0 - No response or completely off-topic. DOCUMENT ANALYSIS EXPECTATIONS: — Doc 1: McKinley's economic/commercial framing; distinguish from humanitarian yellow-press justification; note 'enforcing American interests' as the operative phrase. — Doc 2: Teller's explicit anti-annexation intent; note its unanimous passage alongside the war authorization; significance = set up later contradiction with Platt. — Doc 3: Platt's intervention rights and naval basing provisions; note this was imposed as a condition of U.S. military withdrawal; Cuba had no real choice; significance = established protectorate in all but name. KEY EVIDENCE EXPECTED: Mahan's influence; De Lôme Letter; USS Maine (Feb. 15, 1898); Commodore Dewey Manila Bay (May 1, 1898); Battle of San Juan Hill; Treaty of Paris (1898); Philippine acquisition; Teller-to-Platt contradiction; Guantanamo Bay lease (still in force); Cuba as protectorate 1901–1934.